



AMY RAYGADA

Data Director

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data leader with 18+ years building unified data organisations across Data Engineering, Analytics, and Data Science. Currently leading the Central Europe Data and AI Service Line at Thoughtworks: 54 people across Romania, Amsterdam, and Germany, operating as a Centre of Excellence that supports enterprise clients across data strategy, platform architecture, governance, and AI enablement. At SMG Swiss Marketplace Group I built the Group Data Product function from zero, owned the full platform stack, implemented Data Mesh across four business units, and drove self-serve analytics adoption up 100%. I have hands-on engineering roots (data pipelines, ETL, SQL, Python, dbt) and genuine commercial accountability: multi-million-euro budgets, vendor relationships, and a track record of turning data capability into business outcomes. I am equally comfortable in a strategy document, a leadership update, and a working session with engineers. Co-authored a published book series on Data Products. Keynote speaker at Big Data London, Data Masterclass Europe, and Women in Data and AI.

EXPERIENCE

Thoughtworks · Deputy Director, Data & AI Service Line, Central Europe

April 2026 – Present · Germany

Lead a unified Data and AI function operating as a Centre of Excellence for enterprise clients across Central Europe. Accountable for commercial pipeline, service offering development, engagement governance, and a distributed team of 54 across three countries.

- Own and evolve the service line strategy across Data Engineering, Analytics, Data Science, and AI: define offerings, set the operating model, and prioritise competing demands into one cohesive approach
- Run the CoE service model: intake and prioritisation, hub-and-spoke delivery, enablement of non-technical stakeholders across client organisations
- Partner with VP and C-suite leaders across functions to translate technical choices into commercial language and resolve cross-functional disputes over data ownership and priorities
- Own data governance and quality standards across the regional portfolio: policies, ownership models, GDPR compliance, and practical guardrails for AI and data use
- Lead hiring, development, and retention of managers and senior ICs across Romania, Amsterdam, and Germany
- Manage vendor relationships and make build/buy/partner recommendations across data platform and AI tooling decisions
- Represent Thoughtworks at external conferences and industry events; contribute to public technical discourse through keynotes, thought leadership, and published writing

Thoughtworks · Principal Data & AI Strategist, Data Governance Lead

September 2024 – Present · Germany

Hands-on delivery of data strategy, platform, and governance engagements for global enterprise clients across financial services, energy, and retail.

- Defined and delivered company-wide data strategies for enterprise clients: roadmaps covering ingestion, transformation, BI, ML, and AI governance, prioritising competing demands across business units
- Led data platform and analytics enablement for a major European omnichannel retailer: connecting D2C and in-store signals into a unified customer view, enabling self-service analytics across commercial and product teams
- Architected modern data governance frameworks using Microsoft Purview and AWS-native services: ownership models, data quality controls, metadata management, lineage, and federated stewardship
- Built and commercialised an AI-powered data migration accelerator on GCP and Gemini: designed the architecture, wrote the core code, produced the commercial model and sales enablement materials; active pipeline across financial services and enterprise accounts
- Developed AI governance frameworks for EU AI Act, GDPR, GxP, and HIPAA compliance: embedded controls, explainability, and model traceability directly into ML and GenAI pipelines
- Evaluated and guided implementation of AI tooling (LLMs, agentic AI, analytics copilots) at enterprise scale: licensing, policy, and rollout strategy
- Delivered keynotes at Big Data London, Data Masterclass Europe, and Women in Data and AI
- Stack: GCP, Gemini, BigQuery, dbt, AWS, Azure, Microsoft Purview, Python, SQL, Kafka, Databricks

Cosmodata Strategy & Management · CEO & Founder

March 2024 – Present · Germany

Built and run a Data and AI advisory practice from zero, full P&L ownership.

- Advise enterprise clients on data strategy, data product operating models, platform architecture, and AI readiness
- Develop governance frameworks and self-service enablement playbooks for clients building data capability across distributed teams
- Stack: Microsoft Purview, Collibra, OpenMetadata, AWS, Azure, Databricks, Kafka, dbt

Data Masterclass · Data Management Coach

March 2025 – Present · Remote

- Coach data leaders on data strategy, operating model design, and building data organisations that are genuinely useful to the people they serve

SMG Swiss Marketplace Group · Head of Data Product

January 2022 – March 2024

Built and led the Group Data Product function from zero across a multi-brand digital marketplace operating across Switzerland and Germany. Owned the full data platform stack and unified three sub-disciplines: data engineering, analytics, and data products.

- Defined and delivered the group data strategy: roadmap across warehouse architecture, pipeline engineering, BI, governance, and self-serve analytics; prioritised competing demands across four business units into one cohesive approach
- Implemented Data Mesh and federated data product principles across four teams: clear ownership, quality standards, stewardship workflows, and shared KPI definitions across the organisation
- Built self-service analytics capability that let product managers, marketers, and commercial teams work with data without a ticket and a two-week wait: drove data infrastructure utilisation and self-serve adoption up 100%
- Ran OKR process for the central data team, improving goal completion by 75%
- Owned multi-million-euro platform budget, vendor negotiations, and contractor hiring across two concurrent data teams
- Partnered daily with Finance, Product, Operations, Customer, and the Executive Team: data became the operating rhythm of the business

- Organised the inaugural SMG Data Summit (60+ attendees): broke down silos and built shared data culture across the organisation
- Stack: GCP, Looker, BigQuery, Fivetran, dbt

BayWa r.e. Global · Senior Data Solutions Program Lead

April 2024 – August 2024 · Munich

- Led data platform strategy and master data domain architecture for a global renewables enterprise across regulated energy markets
- Defined integration flows across ERP, CRM, and HR systems; implemented data quality controls at each stage
- Stack: Azure, Snowflake, Informatica, Workday, Salesforce

Flightright · Data Engineer / Data Product Owner

July 2021 – January 2022 · Berlin

- Designed and built production data pipelines; ran POC for ETL automation tooling, cutting external vendor costs by 30%
- Translated business requirements into data models; developed and maintained production ETL processes
- Stack: Postgres, Python, SQL, Tableau, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS

Joyn GmbH · Data Quality Engineer

August 2020 – July 2021 · Munich

- Built data warehouse testing framework and data quality tooling; improved data quality by 78%
- Stack: SQL, Snowflake, dbt, DataVault 2.0, AWS, Python, Kafka, BigQuery

EARLIER CAREER (CONDENSED)

Intertec International · Testing and Validation Lead (2013-2016): built testing team from 2 to 14 people in 6 months; implemented enterprise data hub across six US states.

Syniverse · Engineering Manager (2016-2017): scaled automated test suite from 100 to 600 tests; saved \$200K/year.

SKILLS

Data Platform and Architecture: GCP · BigQuery · dbt · AWS · Azure · Snowflake · Databricks · Kafka · Fivetran · Looker · Tableau · Python · SQL · Docker · Kubernetes · Streaming · Lakehouse patterns · Orchestration

Data Strategy and Governance: Data product strategy · Data Mesh · Self-service analytics · Centre of Excellence operating model · Data governance · Metadata management · Data quality · Data lineage · GDPR · EU AI Act · GxP · HIPAA · Microsoft Purview · Collibra · OpenMetadata

AI and ML: GenAI strategy · LLM evaluation and rollout · Agentic AI · MLOps · AI governance · Model traceability · EU AI Act compliance

Leadership and Commercial: Unified data org leadership · Multi-discipline team management · P&L ownership · Budget and vendor management · Stakeholder management · CXO advisory · Hiring and org design · Centre of Excellence design

PUBLICATIONS AND COURSES

Book: *Building Data Products* (trilogy, co-authored with Paolo Platter) · Technics Publications, 2025-2026 · amzn.eu/d/9MMVPiX

Live Course: Data Products and AI Strategy · O'Reilly, May-Nov 2025 · Executive cohort for CDOs, Heads of Data and Analytics, Data and AI Strategists

EDUCATION

Universidad Latina de Costa Rica — Master's degree, Process Management for Digital Transformation (BPM), 2021-2022

Universidad Latina de Costa Rica — Information Technology Management for Business, 2013-2017

CERTIFICATIONS

Product Management for AI and Data Science · Data Engineering on GCP · Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt · Certified SAFe Practitioner

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (native/bilingual) · German (B1, actively studying)

RECOGNITION

Employee of the Year · Data Governance Community Builder · Data Mesh MVP